Project Direction

MY PROJECT IN ONE SENTENCE

I am exploring how a fantasy RPG can turn maths practice into the gameplay itself for South African learners (with a focus on Grades 7–11) because 71.5% of the learners I surveyed report severe maths anxiety and freeze when they must apply a formula on their own, and this connects to my manifesto principle of User Value Drives Sustainable Success.

THE AREA

- Maths anxiety and procedural practice in the South African CAPS curriculum.
- How learners practise maths on their own, after the lesson.

WHY I CHOSE IT

- Only 34.1% of NSC candidates write pure Mathematics (DBE, 2026).
- Gamified maths apps target Grades 1–6; Grades 7–11 have no RPG option.

WHO IT AFFECTS

- Learners: anxious, stuck at execution (persona: Liam, Grade 10).
- Parents and teachers who want honest progress.
- Schools: pass and participation rates.

WHY IT MATTERS

- Anxiety shrinks working memory, so avoidance grows (Ashcraft, 2002).
- Pure maths is a gateway subject: dropping it closes study paths.